

RG02

Drainage: Rivers and Lakes of Rajasthan

3-5 questions a paper out of the 11-15 that Rajasthan Geography carries. The Banas and its Triveni Sangam at Bigod is a documented repeat (2013, 2021, 2023, 2024); Sambhar and the Ramsar sites are a second standing cluster; Chambal dam ordering and Luni tributaries fill the rest.

Rivers and lakes are the highest-scoring block in Rajasthan Geography because the questions are matching questions - river to origin, river to tributary, lake to district, lake to builder. The Banas alone has appeared in four papers. Build the tables once, revise them weekly, and this chapter pays every year.

Drainage of Rajasthan

Bay of Bengal

- Chambal - only perennial
- Banas - longest wholly inside
- Kali Sindh, Parvati, Parwan
- Mej, Berach, Kothari, Morel

Arabian Sea

- Luni - Rann of Kutch
- Mahi - Gulf of Khambhat
- Sabarmati, West Banas
- Som, Jakham, Anas

Internal (about 60%)

- Ghaggar - mrit nadi
- Kantli, Kakni (17 km)
- Sabi to Najafgarh jheel
- Banganga, Ruparel

Trivenis

- Bigod (Bhilwara) - Banas + Berach + Menali
- Beneshwar (Dungarpur) - Mahi + Som + Jakham

Freshwater lakes

- Jaisamand - Asia's largest artificial
- Rajsamand - Raj Prashasti
- Pichola, Fateh Sagar, Udai Sagar
- Nakki - highest, freezes
- Ana Sagar, Foy Sagar, Pushkar

Saline lakes

- Sambhar - largest inland saline
- Pachpadra (Balotra) - purest salt
- Didwana - sodium sulphate
- Lunkaransar, Kuchaman, Talchhapar

Ramsar (5 sites)

- Keoladeo 1981
- Sambhar 1990
- Menar 2025
- Khichan 2025
- Siliserh 2025

Dams & falls

- Gandhi Sagar to Kota Barrage
- Bisalpur, Jawai, Jakham
- Chulia, Menal, Bhimlat, Damoh

Three destinations – sort every river before you learn a single

name

Do not start by memorising rivers. Start by asking where the water finally goes. Every river of Rajasthan ends in one of three places – the Bay of Bengal, the Arabian Sea, or nowhere at all. That third bucket is the big one: roughly 60 per cent of Rajasthan has internal or inland drainage, which means the water sinks into sand or evaporates in a salt flat and never reaches any sea. That single figure explains the salt lakes, the ephemeral rivers and half the questions in this chapter.

Sort first, then learn

Bay of Bengal – Chambal system (Chambal, Banas, Kali Sindh, Parvati, Parwan, Mej) via the Yamuna and the Ganga



Arabian Sea – Luni, Mahi, Sabarmati, West Banas, Sukri via the Rann of Kutch and the Gulf of Khambhat



Internal drainage – Ghaggar, Kantli, Kakni, Sabi, Banganga, Ruparel, Mentha, Rupangarh; about 60% of the state

- Bay of Bengal system drains the east and south-east; the Aravalli is the broad divide.
- Arabian Sea system drains the west and the south.
- Internal drainage covers about 60 per cent of the area - the whole western and Shekhawati belt.
- The Chambal is the ONLY perennial river of Rajasthan; everything else is seasonal.
- The Banas is the longest river flowing entirely within Rajasthan - 512 km.
- The Kakni (Masurdi) of Jaisalmer is the shortest, about 17 km.

YAAD RAKHO

Sort by the last letter of the destination. If it reaches a SEA it is either Chambal-family (east, so Bay of Bengal) or Luni/Mahi-family (west and south, so Arabian Sea). If it just stops - Ghaggar, Kantli, Kakni, Sabi, Banganga, Ruparel - it is internal. Six internal names, and five of them start with a hard consonant: G-K-K-S-B-R.

TRAP

Two constant confusions. First - longest river IN Rajasthan versus longest river flowing ENTIRELY WITHIN Rajasthan. The Chambal is longer overall but is not wholly inside the state; the answer to 'entirely within' is always the Banas. Second - the Berach and the Morel feel like western rivers but they are Banas tributaries, so they belong to the Bay of Bengal system, not to internal drainage.

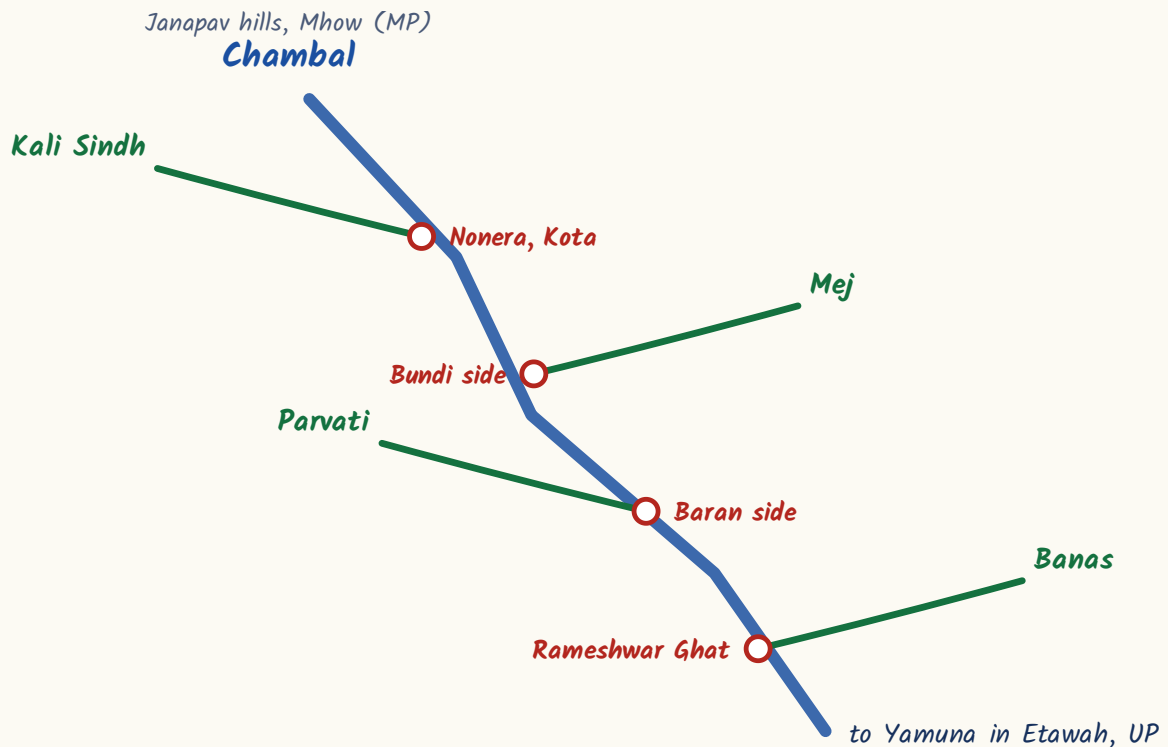
The Bay of Bengal system - Chambal and its family

The Chambal is the backbone of eastern Rajasthan. Its ancient name is Charmanyavati. It rises at the Janapav hills near Mhow in Indore district of Madhya Pradesh, enters Rajasthan at Chaurasigarh in Chittorgarh, runs north-east, forms a long stretch of the Rajasthan-Madhya Pradesh border, and finally joins the Yamuna in Etawah district of Uttar Pradesh. It is the only perennial river of Rajasthan - the only one that carries water all year - and that is why every big Chambal project sits on it.

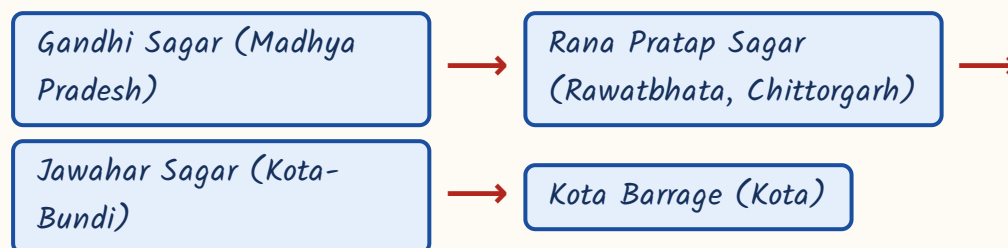
Bay of Bengal system - origin, tributaries, outfall

River	Origin	Main tributaries	Falls into
Chambal (Charmanyavati)	Janapav hills, Mhow, Indore district, MP	Banas, Kali Sindh, Parvati, Parwan, Mej, Kural, Chhoti Kali Sindh, Brahmani, Aalaniya, Chakan, Retam, Shipra, Kunu	Yamuna, in Etawah district, UP
Banas	Khamnor hills, Rajsamand	Berach, Kothari, Menali, Khari, Dai, Dheel, Sohadara, Morel, Bandi, Mansi	Chambal at Rameshwar Ghat, Sawai Madhopur
Berach (ancient Ayad)	Gogunda hills, Udaipur	Gambhiri, Wagli	Banas at Bigod, Bhilwara
Kothari	Diver, Rajsamand	-	Banas at Bhilwara; Meja dam built on it
Morel	Chainpura hills, Jaipur	Dheel	Banas, in Sawai Madhopur
Kali Sindh	Bagli hills, Dewas district, MP	Parwan, Aahu, Niwaj	Chambal at Nonera, Kota
Parvati	Vindhyan hills, Sehore district, MP	-	Chambal, on the Baran-Sawai Madhopur side
Mej	Bundi hills	Mangli	Chambal, on the Bundi-Sawai Madhopur border

The Chambal system



The four Chambal dams, upstream to downstream - an ordering question in its own right



- Chulia waterfall lies on the Chambal near Bhainsrorgarh, Chittorgarh.
- The Chambal ravines - 'beehad' - scar Dholpur, Karauli and Sawai Madhopur.
- The National Chambal Sanctuary on this stretch protects the gharial and the Gangetic dolphin.
- Kali Sindh joins at Nonera (Kota); Parvati and Parwan both enter Rajasthan from Madhya Pradesh.
- The Chambal is a LEFT-bank tributary of the Yamuna; the Banas is a RIGHT-bank tributary of the Chambal.

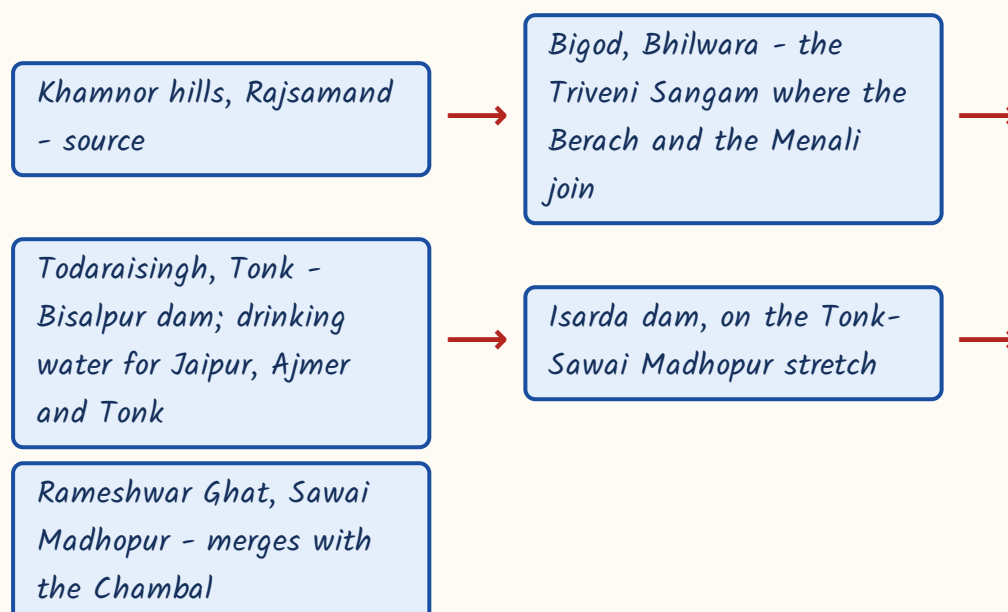
ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2013 as a negative question - which of these is NOT a tributary of the Chambal? The answer was Jojri, because the Jojri belongs to the Luni. Chambal dam ordering (Gandhi Sagar - Rana Pratap Sagar - Jawahar Sagar - Kota Barrage) is the other standing question from this section. Memory hook for the dams: GA-RA-JA-KO.

Banas - the documented repeat, learn this section cold

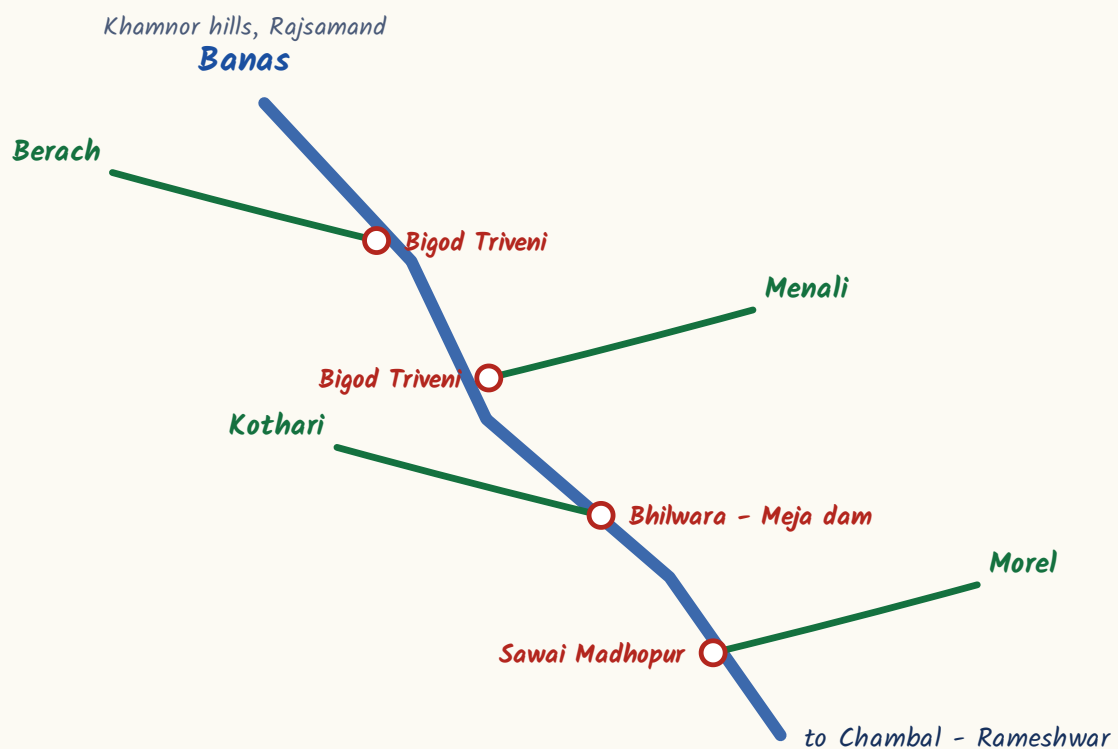
If you learn one river completely, make it the Banas. RPSC has asked it in 2013, 2021, 2023 and 2024 - four papers. The name means 'Van ki Asha', the hope of the forest. It rises in the Khamnor hills of the Aravalli in Rajsamand district, runs 512 km, and joins the Chambal at Rameshwar Ghat in Sawai Madhopur. It is the longest river flowing entirely within Rajasthan and it never leaves the state. Its whole basin is the Mewar plain.

The Banas from source to mouth - every stop has been asked



- Tributaries - Berach, Kothari, Menali, Khari, Dai, Dheel, Sohadara, Morel, Bandi, Mansi.
- Berach rises in the Gogunda hills, Udaipur; its ancient name is Ayad; Udai Sagar lake lies on it.
- Kothari rises at Diver in Rajsamand and feeds the Meja dam in Bhilwara.
- Bisalpur is the single most important drinking-water source of eastern Rajasthan.
- The Banas is a right-bank tributary of the Chambal, so all its water eventually reaches the Bay of Bengal.

The Banas and its tributaries - 512 km, wholly inside Rajasthan



ASKED IN RAS

The repeat cluster in full. RAS Pre 2013 - the Banas originates from the Khamnor hills. RAS Pre 2021 - the Triveni Sangam at Bigod in Bhilwara is formed by the Banas, Berach and Menali. RAS Pre 2023 - the longest river flowing entirely within Rajasthan is the Banas. RAS Pre 2024 - the Banas merges with the Chambal at Rameshwar Ghat, Sawai Madhopur, and a three-statement set on its origin, tributaries and right-bank status.

YAAD RAKHO

Two Trivenis, two mnemonics. BIGOD = B-B-M: Banas + Berach + Menali, in Bhilwara. BENESHWAR = M-S-J: Mahi + Som + Jakham, in Dungarpur. Bigod begins with B and all three of its rivers begin with B or M-for-Menali; Beneshwar is the tribal fair site, so it goes with the tribal river, the Mahi.

TRAP

Do not swap the two Trivenis. Bigod (Bhilwara) is Banas-Berach-Menali. Beneshwar (Dungarpur) is Mahi-Som-Jakham. And the Menali joins the Banas - it is not a Luni tributary, however much the name sounds western. RPSC has used Menali as the wrong option in a Luni-tributary question.

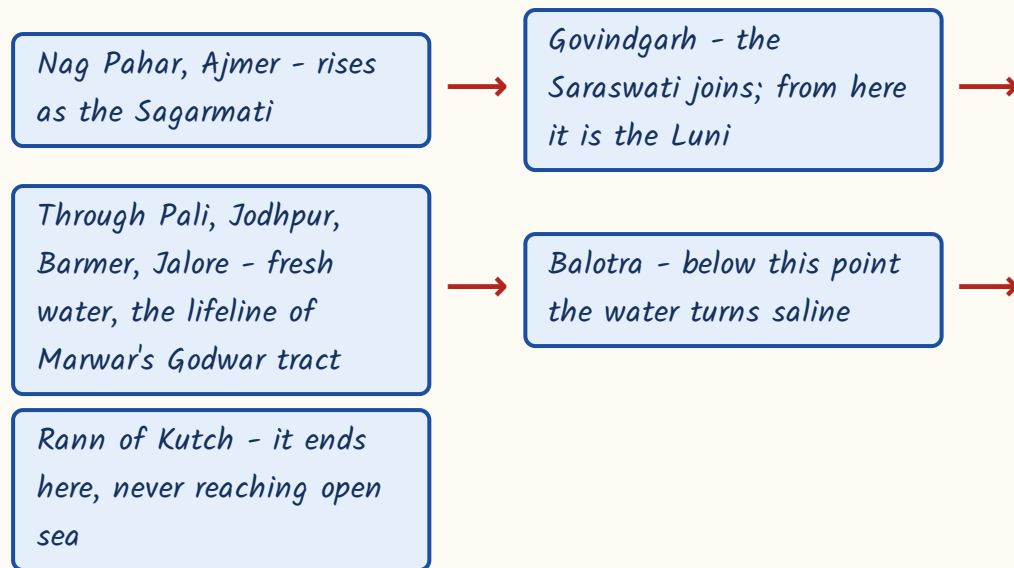
The Arabian Sea system - Luni, Mahi, Sabarmati, West Banas

West and south of the Aravalli the water heads for the Arabian Sea. Two rivers matter most. The Luni is the great river of the desert - its ancient name is Lavanavari, the salt-bearer. It begins on the Nag Pahar or Naga hills near Ajmer as the Sagarmati, is joined by the Saraswati at Govindgarh, and from there is called the Luni. It runs about 495 km and ends not in open sea but in the Rann of Kutch. The Mahi is the tribal river of the south - it rises at Amjhera near Mehad in Dhar district of Madhya Pradesh, runs 576 km in all with about 171 km inside Rajasthan, and empties into the Gulf of Khambhat.

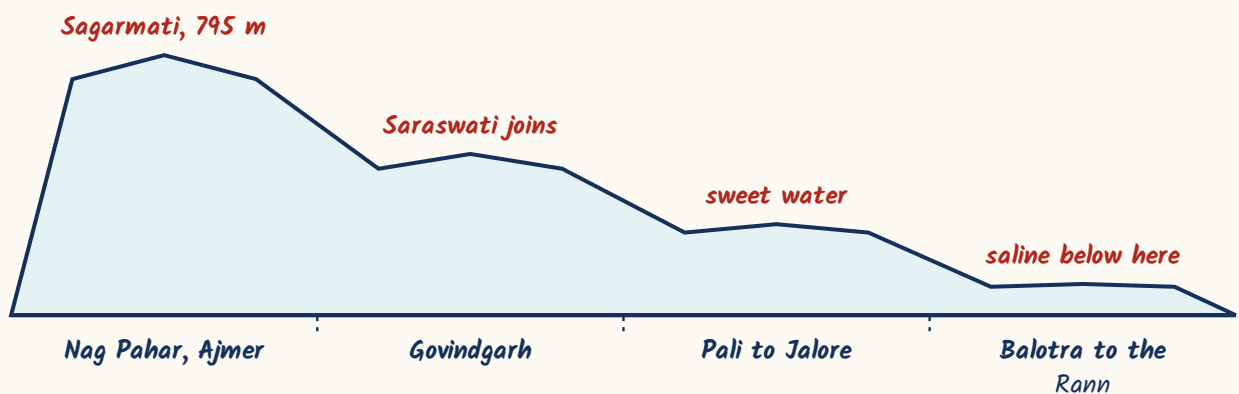
Arabian Sea system - origin, tributaries, outfall

River	Origin	Main tributaries	Falls into
Luni (Lavanavari)	Nag Pahar / Naga hills near Ajmer, as the Sagarmati; the Saraswati joins at Govindgarh	Jojri (only left bank); Sukri, Mithri, Bandi, Jawai, Guhiya, Sagi, Khari (all right bank)	Rann of Kutch
Mahi	Amjhera / Mehad, Dhar district, MP	Som, Jakham, Anas, Eru, Chap, Moran	Gulf of Khambhat
Som	Bichhamera hills, Udaipur	Jakham, Gomti	Mahi at Beneshwar, Dungarpur
Jakham	Bhanwar Mata hills, Pratapgarh	-	Som; Jakham dam is Rajasthan's highest dam (about 81 m)
Sabarmati	Padrada hills, Udaipur	Wakal, Sei, Harnav	Gulf of Khambhat - only about 45 km of it is in Rajasthan
West Banas	Aravalli near Sirohi	Sukli	Little Rann of Kutch
Jawai	Goramji hills, Pali (Aravalli)	-	Luni; Jawai dam at Sumerpur is western Rajasthan's largest

The Luni - sweet at the top, salty at the bottom



The Luni - source to sink, sweet at the top and salty at the bottom



Chambal vs Luni - the eastern river against the western river

Chambal	Luni
Bay of Bengal system	Arabian Sea system
Rises outside Rajasthan, at Janapav, MP	Rises inside Rajasthan, at Nag Pahar, Ajmer
Perennial - the only one in the state	Seasonal; dries to a trickle in summer
Ends in the Yamuna at Etawah	Ends in the Rann of Kutch
Water stays sweet throughout	Sweet above Balotra, saline below it
Deep gorges and ravines (beehad)	Broad shallow sandy bed
Big dams - Gandhi Sagar, Rana Pratap Sagar, Jawahar Sagar, Kota Barrage	Big dams on its tributaries - Jawai, Sardar Samand, Bankli
Tributaries join from both banks	Only one left-bank tributary, the Jojri

- Jawai dam at Sumerpur (Pali) is the largest dam of western Rajasthan - the 'lifeline of Marwar'.
- Sardar Samand dam lies on the Sukri, in Pali district.
- Mahi Bajaj Sagar dam is at Borkheda, Banswara - a joint Rajasthan-Gujarat project.
- Som-Kamla-Amba dam is in Dungarpur, on the Som.
- The Mahi is the only river in India that crosses the Tropic of Cancer TWICE.
- Length order of the big four - Mahi 576 km, Banas 512 km, Luni about 495 km, Sabarmati shortest in Rajasthan at about 45 km.

TRAP

Three traps in this section. One - the Luni ends in the Rann of Kutch, not in the Gulf of Khambhat; the Mahi and the Sabarmati go to the Gulf of Khambhat. Two - Jojri is the ONLY left-bank tributary of the Luni, and it is not a Chambal tributary. Three - the Luni is 'half sweet, half salty' with the changeover at BALOTRA, not at Barmer or Jalore.

Internal drainage - the 60 per cent that goes nowhere

About 60 per cent of Rajasthan drains into itself. The rivers here start in the Aravalli or the Shivaliks, run a short way into the sand or a salt flat, and vanish. Nothing reaches the sea. This is where the salt lakes get their salt - water carries dissolved minerals in, evaporates, and leaves the salt behind. It is also where the strangest exam facts live: a dead river, a 17 km river, and a river that flows out of the state to a lake near Delhi.

Internal drainage - origin and where the water dies

River	Origin	Where it ends
Ghaggar ('mrit nadi')	Kalka / Shivalik hills, Himachal Pradesh	Enters Rajasthan at Talwara jheel, Hanumangarh; sinks into the sands; locally called 'Nali'; Kalibangan stands on its bank
Kantli	Khandela hills, Sikar	Runs through Sikar and Jhunjhunu and vanishes in the sands; Ganeshwar lies on it
Kakni (Masurdi)	Jaisalmer	Bhuj jheel, Jaisalmer - the shortest river of Rajasthan, about 17 km
Sabi / Sahibi	Sewar hills, Jaipur	Najafgarh jheel, near Delhi
Banganga ('Arjun ki Ganga')	Bairath hills, Jaipur	Disappears in the Bharatpur plains
Ruparel	Udainath hills, Alwar	Dies out in Bharatpur
Mentha	Jaipur	Sambhar lake
Rupangarh	Ajmer	Sambhar lake
Khari and Khandela	Aravalli, Ajmer-Sikar belt	Sambhar lake

Internal drainage - where the water dies



About 60% of the state drains inland - no water reaches a sea

- The Ghaggar is identified with the Vedic Saraswati - hence 'mrit nadi', the dead river.
- Four rivers feed Sambhar lake - Mentha, Rupangarh, Khari and Khandela.
- The Shekhawati-Torawati belt is the classic internal-drainage tract of the state.
- Internal drainage plus high evaporation is the whole reason Rajasthan has a saline lake belt.
- The Sabi is the one internal-drainage river that leaves Rajasthan - it flows on into Haryana and Delhi.

TRAP

The Sabi ends in the Najafgarh jheel, NOT in Sambhar lake - RPSC has set exactly that wrong pairing. And the Kantli does not empty into Sambhar either; it simply dies in the sands of Jhunjhunu. The four Sambhar feeders are Mentha, Rupangarh, Khari and Khandela, and only those four.

Dams and waterfalls - the quick-reference tables

Dam-to-river matching is a standing RPSC format and it is pure recall. Keep this table separate from the irrigation chapter's canal material - here you only need the dam, its river and its district.

Dam to river to district

Dam / project	River	District
Gandhi Sagar	Chambal	Madhya Pradesh (upstream of Rajasthan)
Rana Pratap Sagar	Chambal	Rawatbhata, Chittorgarh
Jawahar Sagar	Chambal	Kota-Bundi
Kota Barrage	Chambal	Kota
Bisalpur	Banas	Todaraisingh, Tonk
Isarda	Banas	Tonk-Sawai Madhopur
Meja	Kothari	Bhilwara
Jawai	Jawai	Sumerpur, Pali
Sardar Samand	Sukri	Pali
Jakham	Jakham	Pratapgarh - highest dam of Rajasthan, about 81 m
Mahi Bajaj Sagar	Mahi	Borkheda, Banswara
Som-Kamla-Amba	Som	Dungarpur
Panchana	Gambhir	Karauli

Waterfalls of Rajasthan

Waterfall	River / setting	District
Chulia	Chambal, near Bhainsrorgarh	Chittorgarh
Menal	Menali	Chittorgarh-Bhilwara border area
Bhimlat	Mej basin	Bundi
Damoh	Chambal ravine country	Dholpur
Apsara falls	Near Mount Abu	Sirohi

YAAD RAKHO

Waterfall shortcut - Chulia and Menal are both Chittorgarh side, Bhimlat is Bundi, Damoh is Dholpur, Apsara is Abu. Two C's together, then B-B, D-D and A-A. Every pair shares a letter.

Freshwater lakes - mostly man-made, mostly Mewar

Almost every freshwater lake in Rajasthan is artificial. A ruler dammed a stream, the water backed up, and a lake appeared with his name on it. That is why lake-to-builder matching is such a reliable RPSC format. Two facts carry outsized weight - Jaisamand is traditionally described as the largest artificial freshwater lake in Asia, and Nakki at Mount Abu is the highest lake in Rajasthan and the only one that freezes.

Freshwater lakes - the Mewar cluster

Lake	District	Builder / key fact
Jaisamand (Dhebar)	Udaipur	Maharana Jai Singh, 1685-91, on the Gomti; Asia's largest artificial freshwater lake; seven islands settled by Bhil and Mina families
Rajsamand	Rajsamand	Maharana Raj Singh I, 1662, on the Gomti; its Nauchowki embankment carries the Raj Prashasti - India's largest inscription, 25 slabs, composed by Ranchhod Bhatt

Lake	District	Builder / key fact
Pichola	Udaipur	Dug in Rana Lakha's reign by a Banjara; Jag Mandir and Jag Niwas stand in it
Fateh Sagar	Udaipur	Maharana Fateh Singh; the Udaipur Solar Observatory sits on an island in it
Udai Sagar	Udaipur	Maharana Udai Singh, built on the Berach
Swaroop Sagar	Udaipur	Links Pichola with Fateh Sagar
Badi (Jiyan Sagar)	Udaipur	Famine-relief work of Maharana Raj Singh II

Freshwater lakes – the rest of the state

Lake	District	Key fact
Ana Sagar	Ajmer	Built by Arnoraj Chauhan; Jahangir's Daulat Bagh and Shah Jahan's baradari on its bank
Foy Sagar	Ajmer	1892 famine-relief work, named for the engineer Foy
Pushkar	Ajmer	Natural lake, 52 ghats, the Brahma temple; the Pushkar fair
Nakki	Sirohi (Mount Abu)	Highest lake in Rajasthan and the only one that freezes
Balsamand	Jodhpur	Built in 1159 – among the oldest artificial lakes of the state
Kaylana	Jodhpur	Built by Pratap Singh, 1872
Siliserh	Alwar	Palace lake; became a Ramsar site in 2025
Gadsisar	Jaisalmer	The old water supply of Jaisalmer city
Kolayat and Gajner	Bikaner	Kolayat has the Kapil Muni temple and its annual fair
Ramgarh crater lake	Baran	Sits in a meteorite impact crater; a notified geo-heritage site
Menar	Udaipur	The 'bird village' wetland; Ramsar site since 2025

YAAD RAKHO

Lake-to-builder, four pairs that come up again and again - Ana Sagar goes with Arnoraj (both start with A), Rajsamand with Raj Singh (both start with Raj), Udai Sagar with Udai Singh, Fateh Sagar with Fateh Singh. The lake is named after the man in three of the four cases. Jaisamand is the fifth - Jai Singh.

TRAP

The Jai Singh who built Jaisamand is MAHARANA Jai Singh of Mewar in the 1680s - not Sawai Jai Singh II of Jaipur, who founded Jaipur in 1727. Second trap: Fateh Sagar carries the Udaipur Solar Observatory, not Pichola. Third: Gadsisar is in Jaisalmer, never Barmer - RPSC has used that exact wrong pairing.

Saline lakes and the salt economy

The saline lakes are the direct consequence of internal drainage. Water runs in, cannot run out, evaporates, and leaves its dissolved salt behind. The result is a belt of salt lakes across the Jaipur-Ajmer-Nagaur-Bikaner tract. Sambhar is the giant - India's largest inland saline lake, about 190 sq km, spread across the Jaipur, Ajmer and Nagaur districts. It has been a Ramsar site since 23 March 1990, it is worked by Sambhar Salts Limited, it is a flamingo habitat, and the Shakambhari Devi temple stands beside it.

Saline lakes of Rajasthan - use the post-2024 district names

Lake	District	Key fact
Sambhar	Jaipur-Ajmer-Nagaur tract	India's largest inland saline lake; about 190 sq km; Ramsar site 23 March 1990; flamingos; Shakambhari Devi temple

Lake	District	Key fact
Pachpadra	Balotra (erstwhile Barmer)	The best-quality salt in India, about 98% sodium chloride; made by the traditional 'mora' method
Didwana	Didwana-Kuchaman (erstwhile Nagaur)	A source of sodium sulphate, not just common salt
Kuchaman	Didwana-Kuchaman (erstwhile Nagaur)	Part of the Nagauri upland salt belt
Lunkaransar	Bikaner	Northern end of the salt belt
Phulera	Jaipur	Adjoins the Sambhar basin
Talchhapar	Churu	Salt flat with the blackbuck sanctuary alongside it
Rewasa	Sikar	Small Shekhawati salt lake
Kawad	Jodhpur	Western salt depression

Lakes of Rajasthan - freshwater and saline



Blue = freshwater lakes, brown = saline lakes

- Rajasthan is India's largest producer of inland salt; Sambhar alone supplies a large share.
- Sambhar Salts Limited works Sambhar; RSMML handles the state's wider mineral operations.
- Pachpadra salt is the purest because its brine is fed by an underground salt source, not by rainfall runoff.
- The 'mora' method at Pachpadra uses branches of the khejri or babool placed in the brine to crystallise salt.
- Sambhar's flamingo season and Shakambhari Devi make it a tourism and biodiversity question as well as a geography one.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2023 as a three-statement set on Sambhar - it is India's largest inland saline lake; it was designated a Ramsar site in 1990; the Mentha and the Rupangarh are among the rivers that feed it. All three correct. Sambhar and Keoladeo as a Ramsar pair have also come up in 2016. Learn the 1990 date.

TRAP

Lunkaransar is in BIKANER; Talchhapar is in CHURU. Students swap them because both sound like desert names. Also - Pachpadra gives the highest-purity salt, but Sambhar is the largest producer by quantity; a question about 'best quality' and one about 'largest' have different answers.

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): write the salt lakes with their post-2024 districts. Pachpadra now belongs to Balotra district, and Didwana and Kuchaman to Didwana-Kuchaman district - both were created in 2023 and both survived the December 2024 denotification, so Barmer and Nagaur are no longer the correct answers for them. Sambhar is unaffected: it still straddles the Jaipur, Ajmer and Nagaur tract. On the wetland side, Rajasthan's Ramsar count moved to five in 2025 with Menar, Khichan and Siliserh, so a lake question can now double as a Ramsar question.

Ramsar sites and the final sweep

Ramsar sites are wetlands of international importance listed under the Ramsar Convention of 1971. For decades Rajasthan had only two. Three more were added in 2025, so the number you write today is FIVE. This is exactly the kind of fact RPSC updates and then tests, so carry the date with it.

The five Ramsar sites of Rajasthan (as of September 2026)

Site	District	Listed	Why it qualified
Keoladeo Ghana	Bharatpur	1981	Rajasthan's first; also a UNESCO World Heritage site and a national park
Sambhar	Jaipur-Ajmer-Nagaur	1990 (23 March)	India's largest inland saline lake; flamingo habitat
Menar	Udaipur	2025	The 'bird village' wetland complex of Mewar
Khichan	Phalodi (erstwhile Jodhpur)	2025	Winter home of the demoiselle crane, the 'kurjan'
Siliserh Lake	Alwar	2025	Aravalli foothill lake; India's 95th Ramsar site

CURRENT LINK

Current link (as of September 2026): Rajasthan has FIVE Ramsar sites after the 2025 additions of Menar, Khichan and Siliserh Lake. Menar and Khichan were listed together and took India's tally to 91; Siliserh followed as India's 95th. Note the district shift too - Khichan is now in Phalodi district, carved out of Jodhpur in 2023 and retained in the December 2024 review. Re-check India's national Ramsar total closer to the exam, since it keeps rising.

YAAD RAKHO

Last-week sweep. Chambal - Janapav, Charmanyavati, only perennial, Chaurasigarh entry, Yamuna at Etawah, GA-RA-JA-KO dams. Banas - Khamnor, 512 km, longest wholly inside Rajasthan, Bigod Triveni, Bisalpur, Rameshwar Ghat. Luni - Nag Pahar, Sagarmati plus Saraswati, Jojri the only left-bank tributary, saline below Balotra, Rann of Kutch. Mahi - Amjhera, crosses the Tropic of Cancer twice, Beneshwar Triveni. Internal - Ghaggar the dead river, Kakni the shortest at 17 km, Sabi to Najafgarh. Lakes - Jaisamand largest artificial freshwater in Asia, Nakki highest and the only one that freezes, Sambhar largest inland saline, Pachpadra purest salt. Five Ramsar sites.

REVISION RECAP

1. Roughly 60% of Rajasthan has internal drainage; the rest splits between the Bay of Bengal (Chambal system) and the Arabian Sea (Luni, Mahi, Sabarmati, West Banas).
2. Chambal - ancient Charmanyavati, rises at Janapav hills (Mhow, Indore, MP), enters Rajasthan at Chaurasigarh (Chittorgarh), joins the Yamuna at Etawah; the state's only perennial river.
3. Chambal dams upstream to downstream - Gandhi Sagar, Rana Pratap Sagar (Rawatbhata), Jawahar Sagar, Kota Barrage; Chulia falls near Bhainsrorgarh.
4. Kali Sindh joins the Chambal at Nonera (Kota); Parvati and Parwan enter from Madhya Pradesh; Jojri is NOT a Chambal tributary.

5. Banas - 'Van ki Asha', Khamnor hills (Rajsamand), 512 km, longest river entirely within Rajasthan, joins the Chambal at Rameshwar Ghat (Sawai Madhopur).
6. Triveni Sangam at Bigod (Bhilwara) = Banas + Berach + Menali; Beneshwar (Dungarpur) = Mahi + Som + Jakham.
7. Bisalpur dam on the Banas at Todaraisingh (Tonk) supplies Jaipur, Ajmer and Tonk; Meja dam on the Kothari (Bhilwara).
8. Luni - Lavanavari, rises at Nag Pahar (Ajmer) as the Sagarmati, Saraswati joins at Govindgarh, about 495 km, saline below Balotra, ends in the Rann of Kutch.
9. Jojri is the Luni's only left-bank tributary; Sukri, Mithri, Bandi, Jawai, Guhiya, Sagi and Khari join from the right.
10. Jawai dam at Sumerpur (Pali) is western Rajasthan's largest - the lifeline of Marwar; Sardar Samand is on the Sukri.
11. Mahi - Amjhera (Dhar, MP), 576 km with about 171 km in Rajasthan, the only Indian river crossing the Tropic of Cancer twice, ends in the Gulf of Khambhat; Mahi Bajaj Sagar at Borkheda (Banswara).
12. Jakham dam (Pratapgarh) is Rajasthan's highest at about 81 m; Som-Kamla-Amba is in Dungarpur.
13. Ghaggar - the 'mrit nadi', Vedic Saraswati, enters at Talwara jheel (Hanumangarh), locally 'Nali', Kalibangan on its bank.
14. Kakni (Masurdi) of Jaisalmer is the shortest river at about 17 km; Sabi ends in the Najafgarh jheel; Banganga and Ruparel die in the Bharatpur plains; Kantli vanishes in Jhunjhunu.
15. Sambhar is fed by the Mentha, Rupangarh, Khari and Khandela.
16. Jaisamand (Dhebar) on the Gomti, Maharana Jai Singh 1685-91 - Asia's largest artificial freshwater lake, seven islands; Rajsamand (Raj Singh I, 1662) carries the Raj Prashasti on its Nauchowki.
17. Nakki (Mount Abu, Sirohi) is the highest lake and the only one that freezes; Ramgarh in Baran sits in a meteorite crater.
18. Ana Sagar - Arnoraj Chauhan (Ajmer); Foy Sagar - 1892 famine relief; Fateh Sagar carries the Udaipur Solar Observatory; Udai Sagar is on the Berach.
19. Sambhar - India's largest inland saline lake, about 190 sq km, Ramsar since 23 March 1990; Pachpadra (Balotra) gives the purest salt at about 98% NaCl by the 'mora' method; Didwana yields sodium sulphate.
20. As of September 2026 Rajasthan has five Ramsar sites - Keoladeo Ghana 1981, Sambhar 1990, Menar 2025, Khichan (Phalodi) 2025 and Siliserh, Alwar 2025.